

IT Support Knowledge Base

Employee Self-Service Guide

This document provides step-by-step solutions for common IT issues. Please review the relevant section before contacting IT support. Following these guidelines can help resolve most issues quickly.

1. How to Change Your Password

Changing your password regularly is important for maintaining account security. We recommend changing your password every 90 days. Follow these steps to change your password:

For Windows Login Password:

Step 1: Press Ctrl + Alt + Delete on your keyboard simultaneously. Step 2: Click on 'Change a password' from the menu that appears. Step 3: Enter your current password in the first field. Step 4: Enter your new password in the second field. Your new password must be at least 12 characters long, contain at least one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character. Step 5: Re-enter your new password in the confirmation field. Step 6: Press Enter or click the arrow button to confirm the change. You will see a confirmation message if the password was changed successfully.

For Email/Office 365 Password:

Step 1: Go to <https://myaccount.microsoft.com> and sign in with your company email. Step 2: Click on 'Security info' in the left sidebar. Step 3: Click 'Change password' button. Step 4: Enter your current password and then your new password twice. Step 5: Click 'Submit' to save the changes. Note: Your Office 365 password may be synchronized with your Windows login, depending on company policy.

2. What to Do if Your Screen Gets Frozen

A frozen screen can be frustrating, but there are several methods to resolve this issue. Try these solutions in order:

Method 1: Wait and Check

Sometimes the computer is processing a large task and may appear frozen. Wait for 2-3 minutes to see if the system responds. Check if the hard drive light is blinking, which indicates the computer is still working.

Method 2: Use Task Manager

Press Ctrl + Shift + Escape to open Task Manager. If it opens, look for applications marked as 'Not Responding' in the Processes tab. Select the frozen application and click 'End Task' to close it. This usually resolves the freeze without losing work in other applications.

Method 3: Force Restart

If the above methods don't work, press and hold the power button on your computer for 10 seconds until it shuts down completely. Wait 30 seconds, then press the power button again to restart. Important: This may cause you to lose any unsaved work, so use this as a last resort.

3. What to Do if Your Account is Blocked

Account lockouts typically occur after multiple failed login attempts or due to security policies. Here's how to resolve this issue:

Reason 1: Too Many Failed Password Attempts

If you entered your password incorrectly 5 or more times, your account will be automatically locked for 30 minutes. Simply wait 30 minutes and try again with the correct password. Make sure Caps Lock is off and you're using the correct keyboard layout.

Reason 2: Password Expired

Company policy requires password changes every 90 days. If your password has expired, you'll see a message prompting you to change it. Follow the on-screen instructions to create a new password. If you cannot access the password change screen, contact IT support.

Reason 3: Security Alert

If there was suspicious activity on your account (login from unusual location, multiple failed attempts from different devices), IT Security may have manually locked your account. In this case, you must contact IT Support directly at ext. 5555 or email itsupport@company.com to verify your identity and unlock your account.

Self-Service Account Unlock:

If you've set up security questions, visit <https://passwordreset.company.com> and click 'Unlock my account'. Answer your security questions correctly to unlock your account immediately. If you haven't set up security questions, contact IT Support for assistance.

4. How to Reset a Forgotten Password

If you've forgotten your password completely and cannot log in, follow these steps to reset it:

Option 1: Self-Service Password Reset (Recommended)

Step 1: Go to <https://passwordreset.company.com> from any device with internet access. Step 2: Enter your company email address and click 'Next'. Step 3: Choose a verification method: a) Text message to your registered mobile phone, b) Email to your personal email address, or c) Answer security questions. Step 4: Enter the verification code or answer the questions. Step 5: Create a new password following the password requirements (minimum 12 characters, including uppercase, lowercase, number, and special character). Step 6: Click 'Submit' and wait 5-10 minutes for the change to sync across all systems.

Option 2: Contact IT Support

If you cannot use self-service reset, contact IT Support through one of these channels: Phone: Extension 5555 (internal) or +1-555-123-4567 (external). Email: itsupport@company.com. Walk-in: IT Support desk, Building A, Room 101. Hours: Monday-Friday, 8 AM - 6 PM. You will need to verify your identity by providing your employee ID and answering security questions before a temporary password can be issued.

5. How to Connect to VPN (Remote Access)

VPN (Virtual Private Network) is required to access company resources when working remotely. Follow these steps to connect:

First-Time Setup:

Step 1: Download the company VPN client from <https://vpn.company.com/download>. Step 2: Install the application by running the downloaded file and following the prompts. Step 3: When installation completes, open the VPN client from your Start menu or Applications folder. Step 4: Enter the server address: `vpn.company.com`. Step 5: Enter your company username (same as your email, without `@company.com`) and password. Step 6: For first-time setup, you'll be asked to set up two-factor authentication using the Microsoft Authenticator app on your mobile phone.

Daily Connection:

Step 1: Open the VPN client application. Step 2: Click 'Connect' (server address should be saved). Step 3: Enter your password when prompted. Step 4: Approve the two-factor authentication request on your phone. Step 5: Wait for 'Connected' status to appear. You can now access company resources. Remember to disconnect the VPN when you're done working to free up network resources.

Troubleshooting VPN Issues:

If you cannot connect: 1) Check your internet connection first. 2) Restart the VPN client. 3) Verify your password hasn't expired. 4) Ensure your Authenticator app is working correctly. 5) Try disconnecting from any other VPN or proxy services. If issues persist, contact IT Support with the error message displayed.

6. How to Request New Software Installation

Due to security policies, employees cannot install software directly. Here's how to request software:

For Pre-Approved Software:

The company maintains a catalog of pre-approved software. To check and install: Step 1: Open the 'Software Center' application from your Start menu. Step 2: Browse or search for the software you need. Step 3: Click 'Install' next to the application. Step 4: The installation will proceed automatically (may take 10-30 minutes). Pre-approved software includes: Microsoft Office suite, Adobe Reader, Zoom, Slack, and various development tools. No IT ticket required for pre-approved software.

For New Software Requests:

If the software you need is not in the Software Center: Step 1: Go to the IT Service Portal at <https://itportal.company.com>. Step 2: Click 'New Request' and select 'Software Installation Request'. Step 3: Fill in the required information: software name, vendor, business justification, and whether it's free or requires a license purchase. Step 4: Submit the request. Your manager will receive an approval notification. Step 5: After manager approval, IT Security will review the software for compliance. Step 6: If approved, IT will contact you to schedule installation. Note: The approval process typically takes 3-5 business days. Urgent requests should be flagged as 'High Priority' with appropriate business justification.

Need More Help? Contact IT Support: Phone ext. 5555 | Email: itsupport@company.com | Portal: <https://itportal.company.com>